MANATOBI / ORIGINAL PRACTICE

英検2級
リーディングトレーニング

第5回 問題冊子

リスニング・英作文を含まない部分練習 ／ 全31問

大問	問題番号	内容
1	1〜17	短文の語句空所補充
2	18〜23	長文の語句空所補充
3	24〜31	読解

使い方

・解答用紙に答えを記入してください。問題冊子には正答を載せていません。
・問題・解説はA4縦、解答用紙はA4横。白黒・片面・実際のサイズ（100%）で印刷します。
・解き終わるまでは、別冊の解答・解説を開かないでください。
・同じ問題をアプリの分野別練習でも解けます。

独自作成した英検2級形式のリーディング第5回です。リスニング・英作文・面接は含みません。公式教材ではなく、CSE・合否換算はしません。筆記全体の公式時間をリーディングだけの時間に流用しません。外部難度校正は未実施です。

氏名：＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿

1

短文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

(1) The city water bureau urged households to ( ) leaking faucets promptly, as steady drips waste thousands of liters a year.

1 rectify **2** recite **3** revolve **4** recede

(2) Because the island ferry carries fuel trucks only twice a week, gas stations must keep an ( ) reserve on hand.

1 arid **2** awkward **3** adequate **4** abrupt

(3) The journalist double-checked three independent archives so that no factual error would ( ) the credibility of her book.

1 undertake **2** undermine **3** undergo **4** underline

(4) Entry to the astronomical observatory roof is granted strictly ( ) weather conditions on the mountain remain calm.

1 apart from **2** in spite of **3** by virtue of **4** provided that

(5) When an unexpected frost hit the valley in April, orchard growers burned smudge pots to keep apple blossoms from ( ).

1 withering **2** wandering **3** widening **4** whispering

1 短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(6) Although the two mayors belonged to rival parties, they collaborated ( ) to build a flood levee protecting both towns.

1 casually **2** cordially **3** coarsely **4** clumsily

(7) New food-labeling rules require bakeries to highlight major allergens clearly rather than burying them in fine ( ).

1 proof **2** press **3** print **4** prose

(8) Not a single ceramic plate in the crate cracked during shipping, ( ) to the packer's careful cushioning.

1 treaty **2** tendency **3** territory **4** testimony

(9) Because salt spray corrodes ordinary iron quickly, coastal railway signals are built with stainless-steel ( ).

1 compliments **2** companions **3** components **4** compromises

(10) Once the auditor spotted an unexplained gap in the March ledger, she examined every receipt in minute ( ).

1 detail **2** degree **3** defect **4** device

1 短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(11) Far from ( ) young apprentices, the master potter's honest feedback gave them clear goals for their next bowls.

1 disguising **2** discouraging **3** dispersing **4** discharging

(12) Passengers wishing to bring a folding bicycle aboard the express train must enclose it completely in a carrying ( ) beforehand.

1 cape **2** cage **3** cast **4** case

(13) The town's botanical conservatory maintains tropical orchids by keeping indoor humidity ( ) at seventy percent.

1 constant **2** contrary **3** compact **4** cordial

(14) Even well-meaning advice can come ( ) as criticism if offered when someone is exhausted.

1 around **2** apart **3** along **4** across

(15) Local fire wardens clear dry pine needles from forest edges every March lest a stray spark ( ) a wildfire.

1 imitate **2** ignore **3** ignite **4** inhabit

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

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(16) The museum's new audio tour caters (　　) first-time visitors who want background stories rather than technical art terms.

1 on　　**2** to　　**3** of　　**4** at

(17) Having worked both on cargo ships and at port customs, Ms. Endo has a comprehensive (　　) of maritime trade rules.

1 grasp　　**2** glare　　**3** grain　　**4** grief

2

長文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Why Supermarkets Put Doors on Open Chillers

Walk down the dairy aisle of an older supermarket, and cool air spills out from open refrigerated shelves. Store designers long favored open cases because shoppers could grab milk or yogurt in two seconds without touching a handle, boosting impulse purchases. Yet an open chiller leaks cold air continuously, forcing compressors in the back room to run almost nonstop.

Rising electricity bills prompted several grocery chains to test retrofitting existing cases with lightweight double-glazed glass doors. Managers worried that adding a physical barrier might hurt sales. When stores installed anti-fog glass and warm vertical LED strips inside the frames, however, sales remained steady while refrigeration electricity use plunged by up to forty percent. (18), aisles became noticeably more comfortable for shoppers who previously hurried past chilly zones.

Enclosed cases improved food quality as well. Open shelves suffer temperature swings near the front edge, whereas closed doors keep yogurt and cut fruit at a uniform three degrees Celsius. (19), spoilage dropped and staff spent less time rotating stock.

What once seemed a risky design change showed that (20).

(18)

1 On the contrary
2 Otherwise
3 Moreover
4 Regardless

(19)

1 Nevertheless
2 Consequently
3 By contrast
4 Previously

(20)

1 supermarkets no longer need electric compressors of any kind
2 customers refuse to open glass doors when buying milk
3 open chillers keep fruit fresher than closed refrigerators
4 energy savings, product freshness, and shopper comfort can reinforce one another

When Soil Microbes Leave Clues for Archaeologists

Archaeologists searching for ancient timber buildings often face a frustrating reality: in damp, mild climates, wooden posts rot away completely within centuries, leaving neither stone walls nor brick foundations behind. Traditionally, excavators locate vanished halls by scraping away topsoil and looking for faint dark circles—known as postholes—where decayed wood stained the earth.

Visual stains, however, can be hard to distinguish from animal burrows or tree roots. Recently, geoarchaeologists have begun analyzing the DNA and chemical traces of soil bacteria living in buried layers. Centuries of human or livestock activity alter soil phosphorus, acidity, and organic matter in lasting ways. Even two thousand years after a wooden stable disappeared, the microbial community thriving in that patch of dirt differs measurably from the microbes three meters outside the wall. (21), researchers can tell whether a vanished room once housed cattle, stored grain, or served as a clean sleeping area.

Sampling tiny cores of soil with a hand auger also protects fragile sites. Rather than digging wide trenches across an entire meadow, teams test small pinprick samples first to map where activity was concentrated. (22), full excavation can be limited to the corners most likely to answer historical questions.

Microbial mapping does not replace trowels and pottery analysis, of course. Still, reading living microscopic ecosystems allows archaeologists to (23) long after timber walls have turned back to dust.

(21)

1 In this way
2 On the contrary
3 Otherwise
4 Despite this

(22)

1 Nevertheless
2 As a result
3 By comparison
4 Until then

(23)

1 eliminate the need to study pottery or stone tools
2 preserve wooden posts intact for ten thousand years
3 reconstruct how ancient spaces were used without destroying entire sites
4 turn modern meadows into livestock stables

3 長文の内容一致選択
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Instructions for the Winter Roof-Snow Safety Inspection

From: Facilities Management Office
To: Second-Floor Laboratory Staff
Subject: Thursday morning roof clearing and window locks

Dear laboratory staff,
Following Tuesday's heavy snowfall, forty-five centimeters of wet snow has accumulated on the sloped roof of the North Research Wing. Because daytime temperatures are forecast to rise above six degrees on Friday, compacted snow could slide off suddenly and block emergency exits. A licensed snow-removal crew will therefore clear the roof this Thursday between 8:30 a.m. and 11:30 a.m.

For safety during those three hours, the walkway along the north wall will be cordoned off; please enter and exit the building solely through the south courtyard doors. In addition, ensure that all second-floor tilt windows are latched tightly before leaving work Wednesday evening, as snow pushed off the eaves can strike loose windowpanes.

Vibration from roof shovels may briefly disturb delicate balances on the second floor. If your team plans precision weighing under one milligram on Thursday morning, please reschedule it for the afternoon or use Balance Room 102 in the basement.

Regards,
Facilities Management Office

Instructions for the Winter Roof-Snow Safety Inspection — Questions

(24) Why did the Facilities Management Office schedule roof snow removal for Thursday morning?

1 Another snowstorm of ninety centimeters is forecast for Thursday noon.

2 The south courtyard doors will be replaced on Friday.

3 Second-floor tilt windows need to be painted before Friday.

4 Warmer Friday weather could cause heavy roof snow to slide and block emergency exits.

(25) What must second-floor staff do before going home on Wednesday evening?

1 Move all laboratory tables into the south courtyard.

2 Leave tilt windows wide open for ventilation.

3 Lock all second-floor tilt windows securely.

4 Clear snow from the north walkway themselves.

(26) What is recommended for teams needing sub-milligram precision weighing on Thursday morning?

1 Postpone the task until Thursday afternoon or use the basement balance room.

2 Place extra snow on top of their laboratory benches.

3 Work beside the north wall walkway outdoors.

4 Turn off all building heaters until noon.

How Seed Vaults Guard Crop Diversity Against New Risks

Modern supermarkets create an illusion of boundless agricultural variety, displaying dozens of breads, pastas, and snacks down long aisles. Genetically, however, global food supplies rely on a surprisingly narrow base. Over the past century, farmers understandably favored high-yielding wheat, rice, and maize varieties that ripened uniformly for mechanical harvesters, while thousands of local "landrace" varieties adapted to specific valleys or dry hillsides fell out of everyday cultivation.

Uniformity carries biological vulnerability. When vast regions plant genetically similar crops, a single newly evolved fungus, insect pest, or prolonged drought can sweep across entire harvests. Wild relatives and half-forgotten regional varieties often hold the exact genetic traits plant breeders need—such as tolerance to salty soil or resistance to a rust disease—even if their yields look modest on prime farmland.

To keep those traits from vanishing forever, more than 1,700 national and regional gene banks dry seeds to low moisture levels and store them in subzero chambers. High in the Arctic archipelago of Svalbard, a global backup vault carved deep inside frozen rock holds duplicate packets sent from collections worldwide, ensuring that regional power failures, floods, or civil conflicts do not erase irreplaceable agricultural heritage.

Yet frozen vaults alone are only half the solution. Seeds stored in jars eventually lose germination vigor after decades and must be planted out periodically to produce fresh stock. Moreover, a seed frozen in 1980 stops evolving alongside shifting climates and pests in real fields. Consequently, conservationists increasingly pair cold vaults with "living" on-farm networks, paying smallholder farmers to keep growing traditional varieties in their home landscapes.

Safeguarding tomorrow's harvests requires both the quiet insurance of subzero rock chambers and the ongoing adaptation of working fields.

How Seed Vaults Guard Crop Diversity Against New Risks — Questions

(27) Why did thousands of local crop varieties disappear from everyday farming over the past century?

1 International laws banned planting traditional seeds in valleys.

2 Farmers favored uniform, high-yielding varieties suited to mechanical harvesting.

3 Local varieties could not be cooked into bread or pasta.

4 Insects ate every traditional seed stored in supermarkets.

(28) Why are wild relatives and older regional varieties valuable to modern plant breeders?

1 They always produce ten times more grain than modern crops on prime land.

2 Their seeds can survive boiling water without damage.

3 They never need sunlight or water to grow.

4 They often carry genetic traits such as resistance to disease or salty soil.

(29) What is the main purpose of the backup vault in Svalbard?

1 To safeguard duplicate seed packets against local disasters, power failures, or conflicts.

2 To grow fresh vegetables inside Arctic rock caves.

3 To replace all 1,700 regional gene banks so they can close.

4 To sell rare garden flowers to summer tourists.

(30) What limitation of storing seeds solely in frozen vaults is pointed out in the fourth paragraph?

1 Frozen seeds turn into different plant species within five years.

2 Arctic rock is warmer than tropical farmland in winter.

3 Subzero chambers cannot hold wheat or rice packets.

4 Stored seeds eventually need regrowing and do not evolve alongside changing field conditions.

(31) What approach do conservationists increasingly favor according to the passage?

1 Keeping all agricultural seeds at room temperature in supermarkets.

2 Abandoning high-yielding crops everywhere immediately.

3 Combining cold seed vaults with networks of farmers who continue growing traditional crops.

4 Relying exclusively on wild plants gathered from forests.